

What Phase 1 built, and what it left behind

Twenty-two modules, closed on 12 August 2026 and in daily use since. This is the record of what shipped — and, just as importantly, the seven things it did not finish.

Status Closed 12 August 2026 Live at 217.76.59.244.sslip.io Modules 22 Reviewed 24 August 2026

Scope

Build and stabilise the internal platform

Phase 1 replaced spreadsheets and WhatsApp with one system the whole firm signs into. It covers four areas: who may do what, how client work is tracked, how people are managed, and what the firm can see about itself.

ACCESS & IDENTITY

Cookie/JWT login with real sessions. Nine roles across a four-layer permission model — role presets, per-user grants, per-user denials, and project membership — so access is described once and enforced everywhere. An organisation passcode acts as a second factor on the changes that cannot be walked back, and every sensitive action is written to an audit log.

DELIVERY

Projects across nine patent-analysis types, each with a technology domain and a standard task list created on the spot. The PID system mints `SQ_26_27_nnn` identifiers with rounds and a full ledger of who issued what. Tasks and subtasks with staffing. Timesheets with backdating windows — free under a month, approved to three, refused beyond. Patents and clients, held confidentially.

PEOPLE OPERATIONS

Attendance with punch in/out, working-from-home as a mode rather than a leave type, and regularisation requests that route to HR. Leave and comp-off with balances and approvals. Expenses from submission through to reimbursement. A people directory with a hard PII boundary — personal details are visible to Admin, Super Admin and HR only, and are removed server-side for everyone else rather than merely hidden. Appraisals, a company feed, and a policy library.

INSIGHT

Performance charts and a contribution heatmap. A team capacity board answering who is free and when. Reports with CSV and PDF export. A daily digest at 10pm IST. Personal and team calendars.

Debt

What Phase 1 did not finish

Seven items were carried out of Phase 1 unresolved. These are not Phase 2 features — they are gaps in what shipped. I re-checked every one against the live database on 24 August rather than copying the old list forward; one has since been fixed.

One of these has a date on it. There are no holidays loaded for 2027. On 1 January every holiday becomes an ordinary working day: attendance marks the whole firm absent, and capacity shows everyone available. The rest of this list degrades quietly. That one breaks on a specific morning, and the deadline to fix it is 31 December 2026.

ITEM	CONSEQUENCE	STATE
No 2027 holidays	Every 2027 holiday counts as a working day — people marked absent, and shown as available in capacity	0 ROWS
No email transport	Every notification is in-app only. Someone who does not log in never learns anything happened	NOTHING INSTALLED
No offboarding function	Every departure is a manual edit. Twenty-five foreign keys cascade off <code>user</code> — this once destroyed 83 timesheets	NO ROUTE
Shared HR account	<code>hr@squarkip.com</code> approves leave and reads personal details with no attribution in the audit log	STILL ACTIVE
Hardcoded escalation address	<code>attendance.module.ts:84</code> routes every regularisation to one named person. If they leave, it fails silently	HARDCODED
Punch location kept forever	Includes home coordinates on WFH punches, with no retention policy. A DPDP exposure	NO POLICY
No reporting lines	Appraisals could not run their manager-review step and the org chart had nothing to draw	FIXED · 25 ROWS

Rule

Which phase does a new request belong to?

Three outcomes, and the distinction matters because it decides whether something needs a scope conversation:

- **A Phase 1 module already does this, but wrongly** — a bug fix. Fix it now, no discussion.
- **It is on the debt list above** — Phase 1 debt. Fix it, and tick it off.
- **Neither** — Phase 2 work. Confirm the scope before building.

The full reasoning behind every Phase 1 decision is in `PHASES.md` ; the user-facing description of the modules is `Squark-Dashboard-Phase-1-Guide.pdf` .